OP-TEE split driver

Part of the TACOS project

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September 17, 2021

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Part I.

Setting up & building OP-TEE

1. Prerequisites

- Ubuntu 20.04 (only this distribution tested)
- Google AOSP repo
- QEMU

1.1. Ubuntu

This guide is based on a clean Ubuntu 20.04 installation on a Hyper-V VM. It should be possible to repeat the results on any Linux distribution and any hypervisor platform, as long as the required packages are available.

At least 60GiB free disk space is required. If the disk is not large enough and the build process is started, the disk will fill, possibly leading to a total system failure without chance of recovery.

The first thing to do when the operating system is installed, is to update the package manager for the right architectures. Run the following in a command line:

```
sudo dpkg --add-architecture i386
sudo apt update
```

Then the required packages can be installed:

```
sudo apt install android-tools-adb android-tools-fastboot autoconf \
        automake bc bison build-essential ccache cscope curl device-tree-compiler \
        expect flex ftp-upload gdisk iasl libattr1-dev libcap-dev \
        libfdt-dev libftdi-dev libglib2.0-dev libgmp-dev libhidapi-dev \
        libmpc-dev libncurses5-dev libncursesw5-dev libpixman-1-dev libpython2.7 \
        libssl-dev libtool make mtools netcat ninja-build python-crypto \
        python3-crypto python-is-python3 python-pyelftools python3-pycryptodome \
        python3-pyelftools python3-serial rsync unzip uuid-dev xdg-utils xterm \
        xz-utils zlib1g-dev
```

1.1.1. Changes from original [2]

- python-serial is not available for Ubuntu 20.04. This package has thus been removed from the install procedure. This should not have any impact, because only python3 is used.
- As python3 is the only python version available on Ubuntu 20.04 (as it should be), a package is added that links `python` to `python3`. This might be troublesome on systems where Python 2 is installed and existing tools use Python 2 by calling `python`. If this is the case, change these tools to use `python2` explicitly.

1.2. Google AOSP repo

The repo tool from the Google Android Open Source Project (AOSP) allows you to manage multiple git repositories using manifest files. OP-TEE uses these manifests to combine all projects into a single development environment based on the specific architecture to be used.

Obviously, because repo uses git, git needs to be installed and setup on the system. Configure git with your email and name.

```
sudo apt install git
git config --global user.email "<email>"
git config --global user.name "<name>"
```

After that, repo can be installed:

```
mkdir -p ~/bin
PATH="${HOME}/bin:${PATH}"
curl https://storage.googleapis.com/git-repo-downloads/repo > ~/bin/
    repo
chmod a+rx ~/bin/repo
```

Because repo is installed in `~/bin`, this directory needs to be added to the path. This should already been taken care of by Ubuntu, this can be checked if the following is present in `~/.profile`. If not, it should be added to the end of the file.

```
 set path so it includes user's private bin if it exists
if [ -d "$HOME/bin" ] ; then
    PATH="$HOME/bin:$PATH"
fi
```

1.3. QEMU specific

Next, QEMU should be installed. This can be done by executing

```
sudo apt install qemu
```

2. Building & running OP-TEE

2.1. QEMU

2.1.1. Download of repositories

OP-TEE uses a central repository containing the manifest files for repo for all architectures. To download all necessary git repositories of the OP-TEE project for the QEMUv7 architecture, execute the following commands:

```
mkdir -p <project-dir>
cd <project-dir>
repo init -u https://github.com/Distrinet-TACOS/manifest.git -m tacos-
    qemu.xml
repo sync -j4 --no-clone-bundle
```

2.1.2. Toolchains

The toolchains required to build any part of OP-TEE are included in one of the repositories downloaded in the previous step. To download the actual toolchains, execute

```
cd <project-dir>/build
make -j2 toolchains
```

2.1.3. Build OP-TEE

The OP-TEE project has three main parts: the operating system, the client API and the trusted applications. These three parts can be built on their own, but to get started it is easier to build the whole system at once. This is as simple as executing

```
cd <project-dir>/build
make -j `nproc`
```

This process will take some time.

2.1.4. Running OP-TEE

QEMU and OP-TEE can be launched by executing

```
cd <project-dir>/build
make run -j `nproc`

# After the command prompt (qemu) appears, press c to start execution.
c
```

This will launch QEMU in the current terminal and two new terminals, one serial connection to the secure world and one to the normal world. In the normal world terminal, you can login using the users `root`or `test`, after which it is possible to run programs in the normal world that interact with the secure world.

To test if everything went according to plan, run `xtest` once logged in. If there are no obvious errors, the build process should have completed successfully. You can run the example programs by executing any of the `optee_example_*` programs present in the path.

The command `make run-only -j `nproc`` is also available to run QEMU without building the project.

3. Debugging OP-TEE

To debug OP-TEE, some additional steps need to be taken to prepare everything.

3.1. QEMU

3.1.1. Download and install gdb for ARM

Normally, if this guide was followed and the toolchains were built accordingly, gdb should already be present in `<project-dir>/toolchains`. The necessary tools can be added to the path by adding the following in `.profile`.

```
if [ -d "<project-dir>/toolchains/aarch32/bin" ] && [ -d "<project-dir>/toolchains/aarch64/bin" ]; then
        PATH="<project-dir>/toolchains/aarch32/bin:<project-dir>/toolchains/aarch64/bin:$PATH"
fi
```

3.1.2. Gdb settings

To make the initialization of gdb easier, add the following at the end of `~/.gdbinit`:

```
set print pretty on

define optee
    handle SIGTRAP noprint nostop pass
    symbol-file <project-dir>/optee_os/out/arm/core/tee.elf
    target remote localhost:1234
end
document optee
    Loads and setup the binary (tee.elf) for OP-TEE and also connects to the QEMU
    remote.
end
```

3.1.3. Debugging OP-TEE

Because OP-TEE uses Address Space Layout Randomization (ASLR), it is necessary to disable it when starting QEMU. This is done by adding the flag `CFG_CORE_ASLR=n`.

Open two terminals. One will be the terminal where QEMU will be running, the other will be used to debug using gdb. Like before, execute the following with the added flag, but **do not press `c`**!

```
cd <project-dir>/build
make run CFG_CORE_ASLR=n -j `nproc`
```

Once QEMU is started, start gdb in the second terminal:

```
cd <project-dir>/toolchains/aarch32/bin
./arm-linux-gnueabihf-gdb -q
```

When the gdb prompt appears, run `optee` to load the symbols and to connect to QEMU. The output below should appear.

```
optee
> SIGTRAP is used by the debugger.
> Are you sure you want to change it? (y or n) [answered Y; input not
    from terminal]
> warning: No executable has been specified and target does not support
> determining executable automatically.  Try using the "file" command.
> 0x00000000 in ?? ()
```

Then it is possible to refer to the symbols in the OP-TEE p. To demonstrate, let's set a breakpoint on `tee_entry_std(...)`, an often called function and continue execution. Th

```
 Set breakpoint
b tee_entry_std
> Breakpoint 1 at 0xe1347ce: file core/tee/entry_std.c, line 528.

 Resume execution. Breakpoint should be hit.
c
> Continuing.
> [Switching to Thread 1.2]
>
> Thread 2 hit Breakpoint 1, tee_entry_std (arg=0xe300000, num_params
    =2) at core/tee/entry_std.c:528
> 528             return __tee_entry_std(arg, num_params);
```

Now it is possible to further explore OP-TEE using gdb.

4. Custom Pseudo Trusted Application

Trusted Applications (TA) normally run in user mode in the Trusted Execution Environment. They are dynamically loaded when executed. When you want to run p in kernel mode, a Pseudo TA (PTA) is necessary. During compilation, PTA's are statically linked against the kernel.

It is possible to create a PTA by adding the sources to `optee_os/core/pta` and including them in the Makefile in the same directory. This way the PTA is included int the os when it is built.

It is then possible to create an application for the normal world that calls this PTA using its UUID and the right parameters, just like a normal TA. This application is created by copying an existing example application from `optee_examples` and removing the `ta` subfolder (as there will be no TA compiled separately). The Makefile of the host application should be updated with the right binary name and the build instructions for a TA should be removed from the parent (C)Makefiles.

4.1. Example PTA

This example shows a simple PTA that prints some text when called from the normal world. This example is only applicable to a QEMU environment and will thus only be built when QEMU is the target platform.

```c
// File: optee_os/core/pta/testpta.c

#include <kernel/pseudo_ta.h>

#define PTA_NAME "test.pta"
#define PTA_TEST_PRINT_UUID { 0xd4be3f91, 0xc4e1, 0x436c, \
    { 0xb2, 0x92, 0xbf, 0xf5, 0x3e, 0x43, 0x04, 0xd5 } }

#define PTA_TEST_PRINT 0

static TEE_Result test_print(uint32_t type, TEE_Param p[TEE_NUM_PARAMS
    ]) {
    IMSG("This is a test of a pseudo trusted application.");

    return TEE_SUCCESS;
}
```

```

/*
 * Trusted Application Etnry Points
 */

static TEE_Result invoke_command(void *session __unused, uint32_t cmd,
                                 uint32_t ptypes,
                                 TEE_Param params[TEE_NUM_PARAMS]) {
  switch (cmd) {
    case PTA_TEST_PRINT:
        return test_print(ptypes, params);
        break;
    default:
        break;
  }

  return TEE_ERROR_NOT_IMPLEMENTED;
}

pseudo_ta_register(.uuid = PTA_TEST_PRINT_UUID, .name = PTA_NAME,
    .flags = PTA_DEFAULT_FLAGS, .invoke_command_entry_point =
       invoke_command);
```

```
# Added to optee_os/core/pta/sub.mk

ifeq ($(PLATFORM),vexpress-qemu_virt)
srcs-y += testpta.c
endif
```

The code for the host application:

```
// File: host/main.c

/*
 * Copyright (c) 2016, Linaro Limited
 * All rights reserved.
 *
 * Redistribution and use in source and binary forms, with or without
 * modification, are permitted provided that the following conditions
    are met:
 *
 * 1. Redistributions of source code must retain the above copyright
    notice,
 * this list of conditions and the following disclaimer.
 *
 * 2. Redistributions in binary form must reproduce the above copyright
     notice,
 * this list of conditions and the following disclaimer in the
    documentation
 * and/or other materials provided with the distribution.
 *
```

```
 * THIS SOFTWARE IS PROVIDED BY THE COPYRIGHT HOLDERS AND CONTRIBUTORS "AS IS"
 * AND ANY EXPRESS OR IMPLIED WARRANTIES, INCLUDING, BUT NOT LIMITED TO, THE
 * IMPLIED WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY AND FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE
 * ARE DISCLAIMED. IN NO EVENT SHALL THE COPYRIGHT HOLDER OR CONTRIBUTORS BE
 * LIABLE FOR ANY DIRECT, INDIRECT, INCIDENTAL, SPECIAL, EXEMPLARY, OR
 * CONSEQUENTIAL DAMAGES (INCLUDING, BUT NOT LIMITED TO, PROCUREMENT OF
 * SUBSTITUTE GOODS OR SERVICES; LOSS OF USE, DATA, OR PROFITS; OR BUSINESS
 * INTERRUPTION) HOWEVER CAUSED AND ON ANY THEORY OF LIABILITY, WHETHER IN
 * CONTRACT, STRICT LIABILITY, OR TORT (INCLUDING NEGLIGENCE OR OTHERWISE)
 * ARISING IN ANY WAY OUT OF THE USE OF THIS SOFTWARE, EVEN IF ADVISED OF THE
 * POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.
 */

#include <err.h>
#include <stdio.h>
#include <string.h>

/* OP-TEE TEE client API (built by optee_client) */
#include <tee_client_api.h>

#define PTA_TEST_PRINT_UUID { 0xd4be3f91, 0xc4e1, 0x436c, \
    { 0xb2, 0x92, 0xbf, 0xf5, 0x3e, 0x43, 0x04, 0xd5 } }

#define PTA_TEST_PRINT 0

int main(void)
{
    TEEC_Result res;
    TEEC_Context ctx;
    TEEC_Session sess;
    TEEC_Operation op;
    TEEC_UUID uuid = PTA_TEST_PRINT_UUID;
    uint32_t err_origin;

    /* Initialize a context connecting us to the TEE */
    res = TEEC_InitializeContext(NULL, &ctx);
    if (res != TEEC_SUCCESS)
        errx(1, "TEEC_InitializeContext failed with code 0x%x", res);

    /*
     * Open a session to the "hello world" TA, the TA will print "hello
     * world!" in the log when the session is created.
     */
```

```
    res = TEEC_OpenSession(&ctx, &sess, &uuid,
                           TEEC_LOGIN_PUBLIC, NULL, NULL, &err_origin);
    if (res != TEEC_SUCCESS)
        errx(1, "TEEC_Opensession failed with code 0x%x origin 0x%x",
            res, err_origin);

    /*
     * Execute a function in the TA by invoking it, in this case
     * we're incrementing a number.
     *
     * The value of command ID part and how the parameters are
     * interpreted is part of the interface provided by the TA.
     */

    /* Clear the TEEC_Operation struct */
    memset(&op, 0, sizeof(op));

    /*
     * Prepare the argument. Pass a value in the first parameter,
     * the remaining three parameters are unused.
     */
    op.paramTypes = TEEC_PARAM_TYPES(TEEC_NONE, TEEC_NONE,
                     TEEC_NONE, TEEC_NONE);

    /*
     * TA_HELLO_WORLD_CMD_INC_VALUE is the actual function in the TA to be
     * called.
     */
    printf("Invoking PTA to print test.");
    res = TEEC_InvokeCommand(&sess, PTA_TEST_PRINT, &op, &err_origin);
    if (res != TEEC_SUCCESS)
        errx(1, "TEEC_InvokeCommand failed with code 0x%x origin 0x%x",
            res, err_origin);
    printf("Test printed.");

    /*
     * We're done with the TA, close the session and
     * destroy the context.
     *
     * The TA will print "Goodbye!" in the log when the
     * session is closed.
     */

    TEEC_CloseSession(&sess);

    TEEC_FinalizeContext(&ctx);

    return 0;
}
```

The Makefiles of the new host application:

```
# File: Makefile

export V?=0

# If _HOST or _TA specific compilers are not specified, then use CROSS_COMPILE
HOST_CROSS_COMPILE ?= $(CROSS_COMPILE)

.PHONY: all
all:
    $(MAKE) -C host CROSS_COMPILE="$(HOST_CROSS_COMPILE)" --no-builtin-variables

.PHONY: clean
clean:
    $(MAKE) -C host clean
```

```
# File: host/Makefile

CC      ?= $(CROSS_COMPILE)gcc
LD      ?= $(CROSS_COMPILE)ld
AR      ?= $(CROSS_COMPILE)ar
NM      ?= $(CROSS_COMPILE)nm
OBJCOPY ?= $(CROSS_COMPILE)objcopy
OBJDUMP ?= $(CROSS_COMPILE)objdump
READELF ?= $(CROSS_COMPILE)readelf

OBJS = main.o

CFLAGS += -Wall -I../ta/include -I$(TEEC_EXPORT)/include -I./include
#Add/link other required libraries here
LDADD += -lteec -L$(TEEC_EXPORT)/lib

BINARY = optee_example_testpta

.PHONY: all
all: $(BINARY)

$(BINARY): $(OBJS)
    $(CC) $(LDFLAGS) -o $@ $< $(LDADD)

.PHONY: clean
clean:
    rm -f $(OBJS) $(BINARY)

%.o: %.c
    $(CC) $(CFLAGS) -c $< -o $@
```

```
# File: CMakeLists.txt
```

```

project (optee_example_testpta C)

set (SRC host/main.c)

add_executable (${PROJECT_NAME} ${SRC})

target_include_directories(${PROJECT_NAME}
            #    PRIVATE ta/include
               PRIVATE include)

target_link_libraries (${PROJECT_NAME} PRIVATE teec)

install (TARGETS ${PROJECT_NAME} DESTINATION ${CMAKE_INSTALL_BINDIR})
```

```
# File: Android.mk

###################### optee-testpta ######################
LOCAL_PATH := $(call my-dir)

include $(CLEAR_VARS)
LOCAL_CFLAGS += -DANDROID_BUILD
LOCAL_CFLAGS += -Wall

LOCAL_SRC_FILES += host/main.c

# LOCAL_C_INCLUDES := $(LOCAL_PATH)/ta/include

LOCAL_SHARED_LIBRARIES := libteec
LOCAL_MODULE := optee_example_testpta
LOCAL_VENDOR_MODULE := true
LOCAL_MODULE_TAGS := optional
include $(BUILD_EXECUTABLE)

# include $(LOCAL_PATH)/ta/Android.mk
```

5. Serial interrupt in secure world

To accept input on the serial console of the secure world, it is necessary to register an interrupt on that serial console. To do this, two things need to be done: a interrupt handler needs to be defined and the handler must be registered for the interrupt. The console interface might be different for QEMU or Sabre Lite, but the general way of working should be the same.

5.1. Interrupt handler

The interrupt handler is defined according to the `itr_handler` type in `<interrupt.h>`. This struct needs to be initialized with the interrupt location `it` (in this case `IT_CONSOLE_UART`), the flags for the interrupt (`ITRF_TRIGGER_LEVEL`) and the handler function. This function can accept a parameter that is the `itr_handler` structure. When defining this struct, it is (probably) necessary to explicitly state that the interrupt handling is put in the right part of the binary. This is done by declaring `DECLARE_KEEP_PAGER(console_itr);`.

```
struct itr_handler {
    size_t it;
    uint32_t flags;
    itr_handler_t handler;
    void *data;
    SLIST_ENTRY(itr_handler) link;
};

static enum itr_return handler_function(struct itr_handler *h)
{
    // Handling code
    return ITRR_HANDLED;
}

static struct itr_handler handler = {
    .it = IT_CONSOLE_UART,
    .flags = ITRF_TRIGGER_LEVEL,
    .handler = handler_function,
};
DECLARE_KEEP_PAGER(handler);
```

When the interrupt handler is declared and defined, it can be used to enable the interrupt. First, the interrupt handler must be registered and then the interrupt can be enabled. Adding the interrupt handler is done by `itr_add(&handler)` and enabling the interrupt is done by `itr_enable(handler.it)` .

5.2. Serial console driver

To accept input from the serial console during the handling of the interrupt, it is necessary to have access to the console chip and driver. Because the driver is initialized during the boot sequence of the platform, the only way to get this access is by hijacking this process, disabling the standard interrupt enabled by the boot process and call our own function to save the serial console access location.

The original interrupt setup happens in the file `optee_os/core/arch/arm/plat-vexpress/main.c`. A macro called `driver_init(...)` is called with the function that enables the serial interrupt. This macro ensures that the interrupt enabling routine is called during the boot process. To prevent this from happening, the simplest solution is to comment out this line.

To save the access location of the console interface, the function `console_init(void)` in the same file calls a function `register_serial_console(...)` which is a wrapper for an assign operation. We can imitate this function to do the same for us, by defining our own pointer to the serial chip and using this pointer to access the serial console.

```
static struct serial_chip *serial_chip;
```

5.2.1. Handling serial input

The serial console functions as follows: when data is sent to the serial console (for example by pressing a key in the console), it is accepted by the driver, the data is stored in a buffer and the cpu is notified by means of an interrupt. This interrupt invokes our interrupt handler function.

It is in this function that we are able to retrieve the data from the buffer. The interrupt keeps triggering if the buffer is not empty, thus it is necessary to empty the buffer after getting its contents. The following while loop gets a single character from the buffer and prints it as long as there are characters left in the buffer. It is here that we use the reference to the serial console.

```
static enum itr_return handler_function(struct itr_handler *h)
{
    while (serial_chip->ops->have_rx_data(serial_chip)) {
        int ch = serial_chip->ops->getchar(serial_chip);
        DMSG("new cpu %zu: got 0x%x", get_core_pos(), ch);
    }
```

```

    return ITRR_HANDLED;
}
```

5.3. CPU masks

Each system may have multiple cpus. When assigning an interrupt handler to a certain interrupt and enabling it, this interrupt is assigned to all cpus. This means that when an interrupt happens, both cpus will handle that interrupt, calling the same handler twice leading to undefined behavior.

To prevent this from happening, one can enable cpu masks on an interrupt to define which cpu is responsible for handling that interrupt. This is done by calling the function `itr_set_affinity(<interrupt>, <cpu_mask>)` with the interrupt from the handler and a cpu mask that is a sequence of bits, where a 1 at position n enables the handling of an interrupt by the cpu with number n.

It is not yet possible to handle interrupts on a cpu selected at interrupt handle time.

Part II.

Design of a split driver

6. Split driver for OP-TEE

Currently, for *Trusted Execution Environments* (TEE), there exist drivers that can operate as regular devices (think of character devices in Linux operating systems) and enable interaction between user space applications in the normal world and the TEE subsystem in a transparent fashion. This takes all the technicalities out of the communication with these TEE subsystems. This is useful in the case of writing an adapter between existing applications that are already interacting with interfaces of regular devices and the TEE subsystem, such that the applications do not need to be rewritten.

A split driver for OP-TEE is a driver that consists of two parts: a normal world device with a normal world driver and a secure world driver. These two drivers work together to form a device that is able to react to interrupts in the secure world. It is clear that having such a driver makes it possible for any normal world, user space applications to function normally, without needing refactoring, and interoperate with code running in the secure world. Say a program normally interacts with a serial interface; the handling of the serial interface can be delegated to the secure world and a split driver would act as the serial interface.

6.1. Normal world callback on secure world interrupt

Because of the design of TEEs, it is not possible to directly communicate with the normal world from the secure world. It is thus not immediately possible to react to a secure world interrupt in the normal world.

Say that a secure interrupt is registered on a serial interface of the secure world and that this interrupt event is of importance to the normal world and requires special handling there. The interrupt requires the secure world to handle this interrupt with an earlier defined interrupt handler. The Secure Monitor preempts the normal world and starts execution of this handler in the secure world. But how do we notify the normal world of this event?

The normal world is able to communicate with the secure world via well defined channels. This means that threads on the Linux based operating system can easily open communication channels to trusted applications in the secure world. This happens through the well known GlobalPlatform Client API. The normal world can launch calls into the secure world with some kind of argument passing or shared

memory, as described in the Client API. In this way, the secure world is able to populate those memory locations with data of use to the normal world.

It is thus possible to approximate communication from the secure world to the normal world by globally saving data or state of the interrupt handler and its results, which can be polled by the normal world. This is however an inefficient solution, as the normal world needs to do constant polling to the secure world, and defeats the purpose of interrupts.

The solution to this problem is a newly developed mechanism, aptly called *Asynchronous Notifications*. This is a feature that is added to the Linux kernel, but it is still in the middle of the review process. This feature is thus not yet generally available. To check out this feature, you can clone the `tacos-qemu-callback.xml` manifest file as explained earlier in the Download of repositories section. This section will cover the implementation details of this feature.

6.1.1. Feature state

This notification feature is explained in the OP-TEE documentation in the section about asynchronous notifications. It consists of two active RFCs, one on the optee_os repository and on the linaro-swg linux repository. Because the changes to the linux repository are actually changes to the Linux kernel itself, these changes need to be upstreamed to the actual Linux kernel. Although this feature is generally well received by the kernel maintainers, this review process is lengthy, with multiple back and forths between the Linaro developers and the maintainers. It generally takes a few months until the changes are accepted. The changes to optee_os are on hold until the upstreaming process is finished.

6.1.2. Using asynchronous notifications

Luckily, the mechanism that is currently being reviewed is in a working state, which means we can pull it in our working copy and use it to our hearts content. The changes have already been applied to our fork of the linux kernel, and can be pulled from git as explained in the introduction of this section.

6.1.2.1. Secure world to normal world

The notification to the normal world is achieved through triggering a non-secure interrupt. The triggering of this interrupt is platform specific and done via `itr_raise_pi()`. This call is wrapped in a function called `notif_send_async`, which can be called in an interrupt handler in the secure world. An example implementation can be found in `optee_os/core/arch/arm/plat-vexpress/main.c`. When this non-secure interrupt has been triggered, the Linux kernel in the normal world launches the normal interrupt handling process. At system startup, a handler for this kind of notification interrupt has been registered, so that handler is used.

The *hard* interrupt handler `notif_irq_handler`[1] of a threaded interrupt with the name `optee_notification` is registered during the initialization of the kernel. This handler is responsible for deciding what to do with the interrupt thrown, based on the value of the notification. This value is collected by the function called `get_async_notif_value`. The only value that is currently implemented is `OPTEE_SMC_ASYNC_NOTIF_VALUE_DO_BOTTOM_HALF`, but the implementation could easily be extended to allow for different notifications.

Because the interrupt handler in the Linux kernel is a *threaded interrupt* it is also possible to do further handling in the interrupt handler thread called `notif_irq_thread_fn`. This is the appropriate way to execute more complex interrupt handling that could block the kernel for quite some time.

6.1.2.2. Normal world to secure world

On the secure side, a *notification driver* can be registered, should you want to use the asynchronous notification feature as intended. An example implementation can be found in the file `optee_os/core/arch/arm/plat-vexpress/main.c`. However, to write some kind of split driver over the two worlds, we are not fully using this feature, but just using half of the communication channel: from the secure to the normal world.

6.1.3. Practical overview

The following figure shows the sequence of events defined by the asynchronous notifications feature. The OP-TEE driver is the default driver that manages the TEE and thus OP-TEE OS. This driver always registers an interrupt handler for the asynchronous notifications interrupt line on start up. The PTA also registers an interrupt handler, this time for the external hardware interrupt line.

When this hardware interrupt is caught by the PTA, the PTA saves the notification value [2] and sends an asynchronous notification to the OP-TEE driver by triggering a non-secure software interrupt. This allows the PTA to finish execution before the OP-TEE driver handles the interrupt.

When the OP-TEE driver interrupt handler starts handling the software interrupt, it asks for the notification value using a fast call to the OP-TEE OS. Based on this value the driver may choose to do a multitude of things. In the current implementation state, the only value that is implemented is, as explained before, `OPTEE_SMC_ASYNC_NOTIF_VALUE_DO_BOTTOM_HALF`, which launches a yielding call into the secure os. This yielding call is possible because the interrupt handler in the driver is a threaded interrupt handler. This threaded interrupt handler is implemented in such a way that the notification value is requested in the *hard interrupt context*, but the bottom half yielding call is made

[1] `/drivers/tee/optee/notif.c`

[2] This value is manually programmed, based on the interrupt the handler will be handling.

in the threaded interrupt context. This yielding call can thus be preempted, functionality that is not inherently present in the OP-TEE OS.

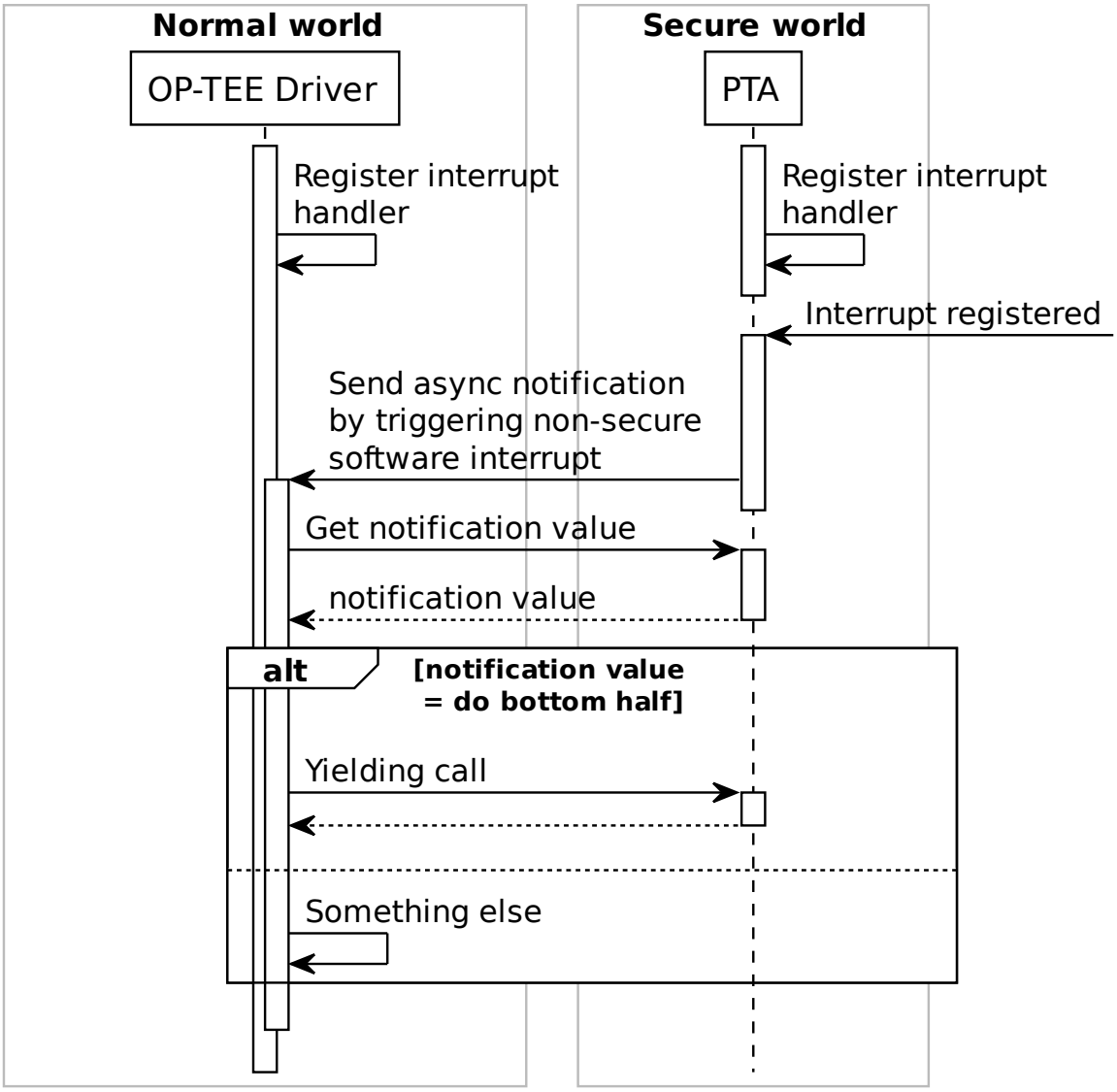

Figure 6.1.: Sequence diagram showing how asynchronous notifications work.

6.2. Split driver using callbacks

Given the new feature described in the previous section, it is possible to construct a split driver over both the normal and the secure world. The added component compared to the previous section is the *Normal world split driver* (NWSD), which is responsible for the registration of a device in the linux os

and the interaction with that device.

Like previously described, when an interrupt is received in the PTA (now called the *Secure world split driver* (SWSD)), it sends an asynchronous notification to the OP-TEE driver. This driver notices that the notification comes from the secure world split driver because of the notification value. Different from the previous section, the NWSD is called from the OP-TEE driver using software interrupts. It thus needs to register an interrupt handler for this at initialization time. While registering this interrupt, it notifies the SWSD of its presence by invoking a function in the SWSD. This registers the hardware interrupt and allocates a notification value, which is then passed on to the OP-TEE driver.

After the software interrupt is triggered, the NWSD catches it. This allows it to make a fast call into the SWSD to get the serial character for which the hardware interrupt was thrown in the first place. This character is then stored in a buffer.

While this interrupt handling happens, the hardware interrupts are disabled to prevent lost characters. This ca be fixed by implementing a buffer in the SWSD and defining a protocol through which the NWSD gets all characters. Multiple hardware interrupts, thrown in the time it takes to handle one, should however not result in multiple interrupt handling cycles.

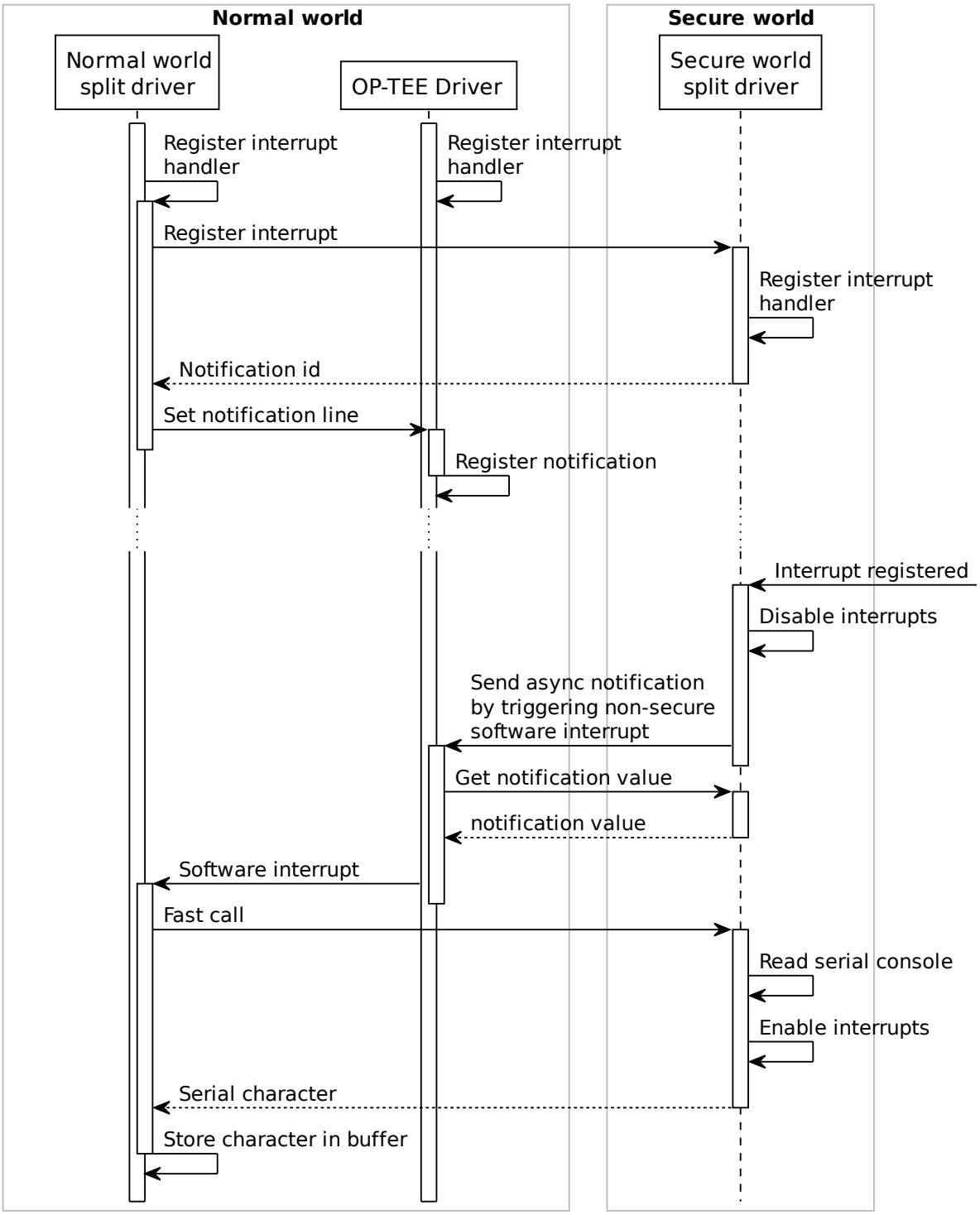

Figure 6.2.: Sequence diagram showing the functionality of the split driver.

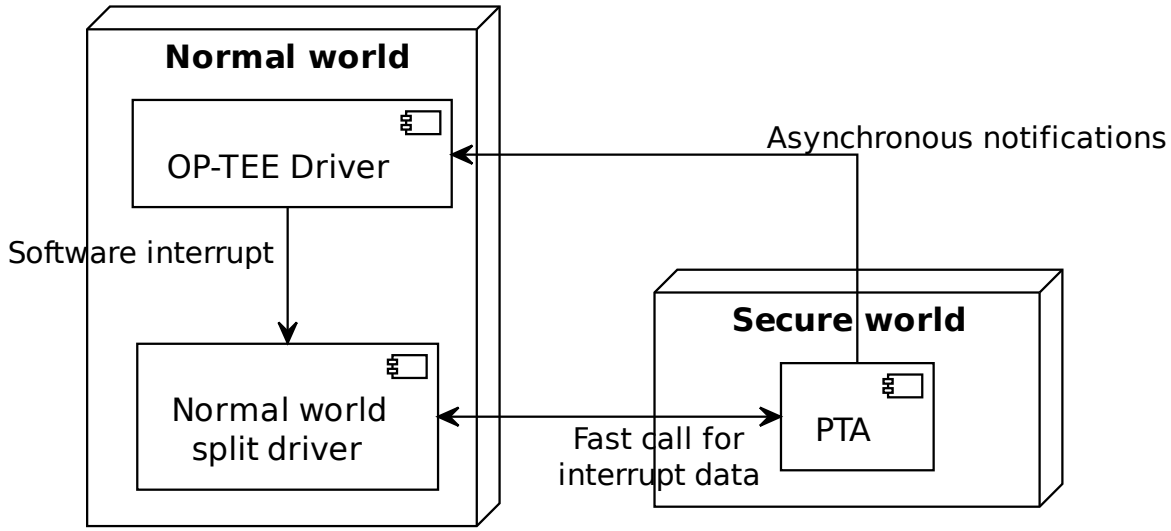

Figure 6.3.: Component diagram for the split driver.

7. Linux kernel Modules (aka device drivers)

In the section Normal world callback on secure world interrupt a mechanism was explained to notify the normal world of a secure world interrupt. We can now use this mechanism to implement a *split driver* that is responsible for relaying these secure interrupts in the secure world to a device interface in the normal world. It would then be possible to, for instance, write a normal world application that makes use of standardized device interfaces to interact with systems running in the secure world.

On Linux based operating systems, device drivers are called modules. These modules can be *built-in*, meaning they are compiled together with the kernel, or *loadable* at runtime.

7.1. Built-in modules

Built-in modules are easy to make. It suffices to include very little boilerplate code into the `drivers` directory in the Linux repository. The structure of an archetypical module is as follows, and for each file a hello world example is given.

```
drivers
+- ...
+- my-module
|  +- my-module.c
|  +- Makefile
+- ...
+- Makefile
```

```c
// drivers/my-module/my-module.c
#include <linux/module.h>
#include <linux/kernel.h>
#include <linux/init.h>

#define AUTHOR  "Hello World author"
#define DESC    "Hello World driver"

static int hello_init(void)
{
   printk(KERN_ALERT "Hello, world\n");
   return 0;
}
```

```


static void hello_exit(void)
{
   printk(KERN_ALERT "Goodbye, world\n");
}


module_init(hello_init);
module_exit(hello_exit);

MODULE_LICENSE("Dual BSD/GPL");
MODULE_VERSION("v0.1");
MODULE_AUTHOR(AUTHOR);
MODULE_DESCRIPTION(DESC);
```

```
# drivers/my-module/Makefile

obj-y += my-module.o
```

```
# drivers/Makefile

...

obj-y += my-module/
```

7.2. Loadable modules

8. Bibliography

Based on multiple original sources from the OP-TEE team:

- [1] https://optee.readthedocs.io/en/latest/building/gits/build.html
- [2] https://optee.readthedocs.io/en/latest/building/prerequisites.html
- [3] https://github.com/ForgeRock/optee-build/blob/master/docs/debug.md#14-debug